AI ON THE RISE · SMALL DECISION MODELS

Amazon cut 98% of a ticket-labeling bill. Same results.

The expensive model was doing a job a small one could do.

Victor Slompo · vssolutions.io

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WHAT HAPPENED

Amazon replaced Sonnet 4.6 with a small decision model

Two Amazon engineers swapped Sonnet 4.6 for Strands Decider to label internal tickets across 20 categories. Per Amazon, it performed just as well at 98% less cost. They ran both on real traffic first, then switched.

THE NUMBER

98%

less cost per ticket than Sonnet 4.6, per Amazon

About $500 per million tickets versus about $22,200.

THE REAL PROBLEM IN COMPANIES

What I see in companies: a giant model on every step

01 Every step goes to the biggest model because it was the first one that worked.

02 Nobody separates the steps that decide from the steps that write.

03 The bill grows, and no one measures accuracy per step.

I'VE ALREADY SOLVED THIS

A building materials store in southern Brazil: small steps, not a giant model

01 The AI never sees the catalog: a simple search hands 8 results to the model.

02 245 counter-slang synonyms mapped across 13,312 products and 136 unit spellings.

03 **9 nodes, one agent, three tools. 65 out of 65 real questions found the right product.**

MY TAKE

Measure instead of assuming.

Amazon ran both models on the same tickets and judged every disagreement before switching. In practice, that is the point: most agent steps are routing and classification, and a small model with measured accuracy can fit. Not every step needs a frontier model.

WANT TO SEE HOW I DID IT?

Comment SDR.

I'll send you the step-by-step of this case by DM. I take AI off the drawing board and put it into production, with measured results.

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